PART D | EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

Re-scope the programme, not the ambition

Five Azure DevOps organisations, ~1,000 repositories, ~1,500 pipelines. Repository migration is ahead of plan; pipeline conversion is behind. Security wants stronger enforcement, legacy products need special runners, metrics are disputed and developers report friction.

RECOMMENDATION - RE-SCOPE, DO NOT ACCELERATE OR PAUSE

Continue repository migration. **Replace** pipeline-by-pipeline conversion with one reusable golden path plus a migration factory. **Enforce** the five non-waivable controls on all new work now, with a dated backlog for the existing estate. **Release full-estate funding only on Day-90 evidence.**

NOT accelerate
Scales the defect, not the fix

NOT pause
Stops the only workstream working

Why this, and not the two obvious alternatives

Option	What actually happens	Verdict
Accelerate	Conversion stays one pipeline at a time: duplication carried forward at 1,500x cost, enforcement deferred again.	**Reject**
Pause	Proven work stops; teams keep shipping on inconsistent pipelines. Restart cost and credibility loss are both high.	**Reject**
Re-scope	Migration continues; conversion becomes a golden path plus factory; controls apply to new work now; funding gated at Day 90.	**Recommend**

Trusted metrics - the only numbers we will publish

Trusted metric	Value	How far to trust it
Deployments	345	Build proxy, not a release event
Frequency	38.33 / project-month	Derived from the proxy
Lead time	20.5 h median	n = 149; 98.0 % link coverage
Change failure rate	0.87 %	3 of 345; project-month match
Mean time to restore	2.0 h median	n = 3 - indicative only

Signals and disposition. Migration ahead → **continue** (protect the one proven workstream) · Conversion behind → **replace the method** · Security asks for enforcement → **enforce on new work now**, dated backlog for the rest · Legacy runners → **governed exception** with owner and expiry · Disputed metrics → **freeze and sign one definition** · Developer friction → **measure time-to-first-green and cut it**.

Priorities and investment choices

Invest now (funded from the conversion effort)	Stop	Defer
Golden path plus migration factory	Per-repository pipeline porting outside pilots	Azure Boards retirement
Policy-as-code and the exception register	Team DORA dashboards that cannot reconcile to Gold	Full ADO decommissioning before wave exit
Measurement spine: one Gold source and a reconciliation gate	Quarterly audits as the primary control	Autonomous production change
Legacy runner isolation - time-boxed, product-attributed	Backfilling historical deployment events	Chargeback and multi-cloud standardisation

Investment shape: platform 4 FTE reallocated from per-repository conversion (not new headcount) · 1 security FTE ring-fenced for policy-as-code · 1 data FTE part-funded by retiring team dashboards · legacy isolation charged to the owning product · tooling neutral to down as five organisations consolidate.

The security ask: five controls, non-waivable on new work from day one

- Default branch protected by a reviewed ruleset with required checks.
- No long-lived credentials; workload identity federation only.
- Secret scanning and push protection on; a detected secret is revoked, not deleted.
- Third-party build steps pinned to full commit SHAs; dependency changes reviewed.
- Production deployment carries an attributable human approval.
- *Legacy runners are not exempted: one governed pool per real constraint, named owner, dated expiry.*

Risks we are accepting, and the early warning that would change our mind

Risk	Early warning	Held by
Golden path is not adopted; teams fork pipelines	Fork count rising week on week	Platform product owner
Enforcement pushes delivery outside the platform	Exception volume growing week on week	CISO
Legacy products block decommissioning indefinitely	Exceptions past their expiry date	CTO
Disputed metrics persist, so progress cannot be proven	Divergence reports between dashboards	Head of DevOps
Capacity: one team is asked to migrate, build and measure	Golden-path backlog age above 2 weeks	CTO - mitigated by the stop-list above

Decisions required from the executive committee

#	Decision required	Owner	By	Consequence of delay
1	Adopt re-scope - not accelerate, not pause	CTO	Day 5	Waves continue without evidence
2	Approve the five controls and the exception policy	CISO + CTO	Day 15	Security posture stays inconsistent
3	Authorise the metric freeze; name one owner	CTO + Product + Data	Day 20	Leadership keeps seeing disputed numbers
4	Fund the 90-day foundation and the pilot	CTO + CFO	Day 10	No evidence exists for the Day-90 gate
5	Endorse the legacy-runner model and funding	CISO + Product	Day 30	Runner sprawl becomes permanent
6	Confirm Azure Boards as system of record	Product	Day 30	Traceability design churns; scope reopens

Day-90 decision gate | resume paused waves and release full-estate funding only when all four conditions hold

- Pilot services build, test, scan and deploy on the golden path, controls evidenced end to end.
- Rollback rehearsed and timed on a real service.
- Definitions signed, quality-flagged and reconciled in writing.
- Pilot teams recommend adoption; time-to-first-green under an hour.

Residual risk: throughput depends on seconded engineers; enforcement without a fast exception route pushes delivery outside the platform.